Theme	Knot Knot, who's there?

Date: 29.05.2026 Duty Six: White

Time	*Min*	*Activity*	*Equipment*	*Scouter*
17:30	15	GRAND HOWL Flag Prayer Register Inspection and bean handout Break	Totem/Rock Flag Register Bean Bags Inspection Cards	Akela / All
17:45	10	Steam Release: Skiing	Skis	Sahi
17:55	10	Ice Breaker: Ice breaker literally	Ice Balls	Akela
18:05	5	Yarn:		Sahi
18:10	20	Silver Wolves: Slip Reef Knott Round Turn and 2 half hitches. Hank a short rope Gold Wolves: Sheep Shank Fisherman's knott Hank a long Rope	Ropes Ropes	Akela Ooh Sahi Icky
18:30	10	Game: Knot Knot who wins?	Ropes	Icky/Ooh
18:40	05	GRAND HOWL Flag Prayer Notices / Badges Dismiss	Totem/Rock Flag Handouts	Sahi / All

Advancements:
Silver Wolves:
Task 46: Slip Reef Knott
Task 47 Round Turn and 2 Half hitches
Task 49 Hank a short rope
***Task 50:** If Cubs were at the Knotting program run by Akela on 06/02/2026

Gold Wolves:

Task 54: Sheep Shank
Task 52: Fisherman's Knot
Task 55: Hank a long rope
*Task56: If Cubs help the Silver wolves with a slip reef/ other then they get ticked here too.

Game/ Activity:	STEAM REALEASE: Skiing	Leader: Sahi	Time: 17:45
Instructions:	In Sixes, Cubs to use the skiis to race around a course. First six back wins. This game works on team work and thinking skills. Skiis are premade above the cupboards.		

Game/ Activity:	ICE BREAKER: Literally	Leader: Akela	Time: 17:55
Instructions:	Best played on a cement floor, under the roof, definitely not on grass. In Sixes, Cubs to stand around a chalked circle. A big ice ball is place in the centre with another chalked circle around it. Each Cub has an ice ball and must throw it at the big ice ball in the middle of a circle to push it towards another six. When the ice ball reaches the chalk line in front of another six, that six looses. Last six to have the ball closest to them wins.		

Game/ Activity:	Knot Knot who wins?	Leader: Icky/ Ooh	Time: 18:30
Instructions:	In Sixes, Cubs to use ropes and each six is to present a knot that has been learnt tonight to Icky and Ooh. The whole six has to do: Slip Reef Knott Round Turn and 2 half hitches. Hank a short rope Sheep Shank Fisherman's knott Hank a long Rope With each member doing at least 1 knot. First six to present all knots wins.		

Yarn: Mbali, Owen and Dante's knots:

The fire crackled, throwing long shadows across the 1st Amanzimtoti Cub Pack's clearing. Akela sat tall on the Council Rock, looking down at three very restless Cubs: Dante, who was currently trying to balance his woggle on his nose; Mbali, who was tying her own shoelaces together; and Owen, who was staring intently at a piece of rope as if hoping it would knot itself.

"Pack! Pack! Pack!" Akela's call echoed through the trees.
The Cubs scrambled to attention, dropping their distractions.
"Tomorrow, we hike to the Whispering Caves," Akela announced, his voice calm but firm. "But the jungle is unpredictable. To pass through safely, you must master three essential knots. If you fail, the jungle will catch you out."
To help them learn, Akela called upon her three trusted assistant leaders: Sahi, Icky, and Ooh.

1. The Slip Reef Knot: Dante's Mistake
"First," Akela said, tossing a thick hemp rope to Dante. "We need to secure our gear bags. If a storm hits, we need to tie them tight, but be able to open them in a flash. What do we use?"
"A reef knot!" Dante cheered, quickly twisting the ends together. "Left over right, right over left!"
"Good," Akela nodded. "But what if the knot gets soaked in the rain, jams tight, and we need our medical kit *instantly*? A standard reef knot will lock up."
Dante frowned, pulling at his tight knot. It wouldn't budge. "Uh oh."
Sahi, one of the assistant leaders, stepped forward with a reassuring smile. "Watch closely, Dante. You do the same first step: left over right. But on the second step—right over left—instead of passing the whole end through, you fold it into a loop, or a 'bight,' and pull just that loop through instead."
Sahi demonstrated with her own rope, leaving a neat loop tucked into the knot.

The Lesson: "That," Akela explained, "is a **Slip Reef Knot**. It holds just as strong under tension, but look."
Akela tugged the loose tail of the loop. *Zip!* The entire knot collapsed instantly, freeing the rope. Dante's eyes went wide. "Wow. Fast food, fast knots!"

2. The Sheepshank: Mbali's Long Rope
Next, Akela turned to Mbali, who was currently tripping over a ridiculously long piece of towing rope she had dragged from the storage hut.
"Mbali," Akela sighed. "We need that rope to secure our tent to a nearby tree. But it is twice as long as we need, and I strictly forbid you from cutting it. We might need the full length later. How do we shorten it without scissors?"
Mbali blinked. "We... wrap it around a tree fifty times?"
"No," laughed Icky, the second assistant leader. "We use a **Sheepshank** to shorten a rope under tension, or to isolate a weak, frayed spot in the middle."
Icky took the long rope and laid it on the ground. She folded it into a sharp 'S' shape, making three parallel strands.
"Now," Icky instructed Mbali, "make a simple half-hitch loop in the main rope on the left, and slip it over the left bend of the 'S'. Good. Now do the same on the right side."

Mbali carefully twisted the rope, slipping the loops over the ends of the 'S'. When they pulled both ends of the rope tight, the middle section bunched up securely, shortening the rope by several feet without a single cut.
The Lesson: "Keep the tension on it," Akela warned. "As long as the rope is pulled tight, the Sheepshank holds perfectly. If the middle of your rope ever gets damaged on a cliff, this knot protects the weak spot by keeping the strain on the outer loops."

3. The Bowline: Saving Owen
"Now for the most important one," Akela said, her tone turning serious. "The King of Knots. The **Bowline** . It forms a fixed loop at the end of a rope that will never slip, tighten, or jam, no matter how much weight it holds. It is the ultimate rescue knot."
To demonstrate, Akela had the third assistant leader, Ooh, pretend to fall into a shallow ditch at the edge of the clearing. "Oh no! Leader Ooh has slipped down a muddy bank! Owen, if we throw her a rope with a loop that slips, it could squeeze her waist and hurt her."
"I'll save you, Ooh!" Owen shouted, grabbing the rescue rope.
"Listen to the story," Akela commanded. "Hold the rope. Make a loop—this is the rabbit hole. The long end going up to the tree is the tree. Now, the short end is the rabbit."
Akela and Ooh guided Owen’s hands through the steps:

1. **The rabbit comes out of the hole** (pass the rope end up through the loop).
2. **The rabbit goes behind the big tree** (pass the end around the standing part of the rope).
3. **The rabbit goes back down into its hole** (pass the end back down through the original loop).

Owen pulled the rabbit end tight while holding the "tree." A perfectly formed, rigid loop appeared around Ooh's waist. Ooh leaned back with all her weight, but the loop stayed exactly the same size, perfectly safe.
The Lesson: "A Bowline never fails a friend," Akela said as they hoisted Ooh out of the ditch. "When you're in trouble, this is the knot you trust with a life."

The Final Inspection
As the fire died down to embers, Akela looked at the three Cubs. Dante was practicing his slip reef on his neckerchief; Mbali was shortening every spare piece of string she could find with sheepshanks; and Owen was successfully guiding them all through the rabbit-and-the-hole story for the Bowline under the watchful eyes of Sahi, Icky, and Ooh.
"Good," Akela smiled, bowing her head. "The Pack is ready for the Whispering Caves. Goodnight, Cubs."
"Goodnight, Akela!" they cheered, their hands ready, their ropes coiled, and their minds tied tight to the lessons of the jungle.